

EMBOTHRIUM

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Chilean fire bush

PROTEACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees, grown for their flowers. Needs semishade and moist but well-drained, neutral to acidic soil. Propagate by suckers in spring or fall or by seed in fall.
E. coccineum (Chilean fire bush) illus. p.86.

EMILIA

Tassel flower

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals with flowers that are good for cutting. Ideal for hot, dry areas and coastal soils. Requires sun and very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown under glass in spring, or sown outdoors in late spring.
E. coccinea, syn. *E. flammea*, *E. javanica* of gardens (Flora’s paintbrush), illus. p.327.
E. flammea. See *E. coccinea*.
E. javanica of gardens. See *E. coccinea*.

EMMENOPTERYS

RUBIACEAE

Genus of deciduous trees, grown for their foliage; flowers are only produced in hot summers. Young plants may be damaged by late frost. Needs full sun and deep, fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.
E. henryi illus. p.75.

ENCEPHALARTOS

ZAMIACEAE

Genus of evergreen cycads, some palmlike, other with a short or buried stem. Frost tender. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Water containerized plants moderately when in full growth, less at other times. Propagate by seed in spring.
E. ferox illus. p.457.
E. longifolius (Suurberg cycad). Slow-growing, palmlike cycad, sometimes branched with age. H 10ft (3m) or more, S 5–12ft (1.5–3.5m). Has feather-shaped leaves, each 2–5ft (60cm–1.5m) long, divided into narrowly lance-shaped to ovate, blue-green leaflets, usually with hook-tipped teeth. Conelike, brown flower heads are borne intermittently. Z11–12 (min. 55°F/13°C)

Encyclia cochleata. See *Prosthechea cochleata*.
Encyclia radiata. See *Prosthechea radiata*.
Endymion. See *Hyacinthoides*.

ENKIANTHUS

ERICACEAE

Genus of mainly deciduous, sometimes semievergreen, spring-flowering shrubs and trees, grown for their abundant, small, bell- or urn-shaped flowers and their fall color. Needs sun or semishade and moist, peaty, acidic soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.

E. campanulatus illus. p.111.
E. cernuus f. rubens illus. p.123.
E. perulatus illus. p.120.

ENSETTE

MUSACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials, grown for their bananalike foliage and fruits (though fruits are unpalatable). Their false stems, made of overlapping leaf sheaths, die after flowering. Frost tender. Grow in sun or partial shade and humus-rich soil. Sow seed in spring or divide year-round.
E. ventricosum, syn. *Musa arnoldiana*, *M. ensete* (Abyssinian banana, Ethiopian banana), illus. p.474.

EOMECON

Snow poppy

PAPAVERACEAE

Genus of one species of rhizomatous perennial, grown for its nodding, poppylike flowers. Use as groundcover, in a shrub border or large rock garden. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or runners in spring.
E. chionantha. Vigorous, spreading perennial. H to 16in (40cm), S indefinite. Leaves are large, gray, and heart- to kidney- or arrow-shaped. Erect stems bear long panicles of small, poppylike, white summer flowers. Z7–9

EPACRIS

ERICACEAE/EPACRIDACEAE

Genus of evergreen, heatherlike shrubs, grown for their flowers. Needs full sun and humus-rich, well-drained, neutral to acidic soil. Water potted plants moderately when in full growth, less at other times. Cut back flowered stems after flowering to maintain a neat habit. Propagate by seed in spring or semiripe cuttings in late summer.
E. impressa (Common Australian heath) illus. p.455.

EPHEDRA

EPHEDRACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, occasionally climbers, grown for their habit and green shoots. Provides good groundcover in dry soil. Grow male and female plants together in order to obtain fruits. Requires full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall or division in fall or spring.
E. gerardiana. Evergreen, spreading shrub with slender, erect, rushlike, green shoots. H 2ft (60cm), S 10ft (3m). Leaves and flowers are inconspicuous. Bears small, spherical, red fruits. Z5–9

EPIDENDRUM

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.
E. difforme. Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for an intermediate greenhouse. H 14in (35cm), S 1ft (30cm). Large heads of semitranslucent, greenish flowers, ½in (0.5cm) across, open in fall. Has ovate, rigid leaves, to 4½in (11cm) long. Requires shade in summer. Avoid spraying, which can cause spotting of

leaves. Propagate by division in spring. Z14–15 (min. 55°F/13°C, max. 86°F/30°C)
E. ibaguense, syn. *E. radicans*. Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 6ft (2m) or more, S 3ft (1m). Bears a constant succession of feathery-lipped, deep red blooms, 1½in (4cm) across. Leaves, 6in (15cm) long, are ovate and rigid. Grow in semishade in summer. Propagate by tip cuttings in spring. Z14 (min. 55°F/13°C, max. 86°F/30°C)
E. radicans. See *E. ibaguense*.

EPIGAEA

SYN. ORPHANIDESIA

ERICACEAE

Genus of evergreen, prostrate, spring-flowering shrubs and subshrubs. Needs shade and humus-rich, moist, acidic soil. Most are difficult to cultivate. Propagate by seed in spring or by softwood cuttings in early summer.
E. asiatica. Creeping, stem-rooting subshrub. H to 4in (10cm), S to 8in (20cm). Stems and heart-shaped, deep green leaves are covered with brown hairs. Bears clusters of 3–6 tiny, slightly fragrant, tubular- to bell-shaped, white or pink flowers in spring. Z5–7
E. gaultherioides, syn. *Orphanidesia gaultherioides*, illus. p.351.
E. repens (Mayflower, Trailing arbutus). Creeping subshrub. H 4in (10cm), S 1ft (30cm). Hairy stems, bearing heart-shaped, leathery leaves, root at intervals. In spring, produces terminal clusters of 4–6 cup-shaped, white flowers, sometimes flushed pink. Relatively easy to grow. Z3–9

EPILOBIUM

Willow herb

ONAGRACEAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, deciduous or semievergreen, sometimes stoloniferous, perennials and semievergreen subshrubs, grown for their deep pink to white flowers in summer. Useful on dry banks; but many species are invasive. Tolerates sun or shade and prefers moist but well-drained soil. Propagate species by seed in fall, selected forms in spring by softwood cuttings from side-shoots.
E. angustifolium f. leucanthum. See *Chamaenerion angustifolium* ‘Album’.
E. californicum. See *Zauschneria californica*.
E. canum. See *Zauschneria californica* subsp. *cana*.
E. chlorifolium var. kaikourense. Clump-forming, deciduous, woody-based perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 6in (15cm). Has persistent, ovate, hairy, bronze and dark green leaves. In summer, bears short spikes of funnel-shaped, white to pink flowers. Z4–6
E. glabellum of gardens illus. p.360.
E. obcordatum. Clump-forming perennial. H 6in (15cm), S 4in (10cm). Ovate leaves are glossy green. Spikes of open cup-shaped, deep rose-pink flowers are borne in summer. Good for a rock garden or alpine house. Requires a sheltered position and full sun. In cultivation may not retain character, especially in mild climates. Z5–8
E. septentrionale. See *Zauschneria septentrionalis*.

EPIEDIUM

Barrenwort

BERBERIDACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering perennials, some of which are evergreen. Flowers are mainly saucer- to cup-shaped with long or short spurs. Provides good groundcover. Does best in partial shade and humus-rich, moist but well-drained soil. Cut back just before new growth emerges in spring. Propagate by division in spring or fall.
E. alpinum. Deciduous, clump-forming perennial. H 9in (23cm), S to 1ft (30cm). Racemes of pendent, short-spurred flowers, with crimson sepals and yellow petals, are borne in spring. Finely toothed, divided leaves have ovate, angled, glossy, mid-green leaflets, bronze when young. Z4–9
E. ‘Amber Queen’ illus. p.263.
E. davidii. Vigorous, evergreen, ground-cover perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 16in (40cm). Dainty, mid-green leaves are tinged bronze when young and divided into rounded, heart-shaped, toothed leaflets. Bears clusters of pendent, long-spurred, butter-yellow flowers in spring. Z5–9
E. epsteinii illus. p.260.
E. grandiflorum, syn. *E. macranthum*. Clump-forming perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). Has heart-shaped, light green leaves, divided into ovate leaflets, flushed bronze when young. Bears racemes of pendent, long-spurred, white, yellow, pink or purple flowers, in spring. Z4–8.
‘Crimson Beauty’ has copper marks on young leaves and copper-crimson flowers.
‘Rose Queen’ has wiry stems bearing clusters of cup-shaped, deep pink flowers, with white-tipped spurs. **f. violaceum** has young leaves that are flushed bronze and produces purple-and-white flowers.
E. macranthum. See *E. grandiflorum*.
E. x perralchicum. Evergreen, carpeting perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 2ft (60cm). Short spires of pendent, yellow flowers, with short spurs, are borne in spring. Leaves, divided into rounded to ovate leaflets, are dark green. Z5–8
E. perraldarianum. Semievergreen, carpeting perennial. H 1ft (30cm), S 2ft (60cm). Clusters of small, pendent, short-spurred, bright yellow flowers are borne in spring. Produces large, toothed, glossy, deep green leaves, divided into rounded to ovate leaflets. Z5–8
E. pinnatum subsp. colchicum. Evergreen, carpeting perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). In spring, bears clusters of small, pendent, bright yellow flowers, with short spurs, above dark green leaves, hairy when young, divided into ovate leaflets. Z5–9
E. pubigerum. Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H and S 18in (45cm). Grown for its dense, smooth, heart-shaped, divided foliage and clusters of cup-shaped, creamy-white, sometimes yellowish-white, flowers in spring. Z5–9
E. x rubrum illus. p.260.
E. x versicolor. Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). Small, pendent clusters of yellow flowers, with long, red-tinged spurs, are produced in spring. Heart-shaped, fresh green